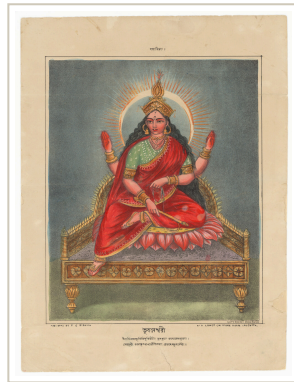


T A N T R A Y A

Supplementary Workbook · The Ten Mahavidyas

Bhuvaneshvari

Queen of Space



Bhuvaneshvari, Queen of the World, holding noose and goad

Fourth of the Mahavidyas · Akāśa, Space

She whose body is the world

Noticing the space that was always already here

Tantraya · Sacred Valley of Peru

At a Glance

RANK	Fourth of the ten Mahavidyas
NAME MEANS	“Queen of the worlds,” “she whose body is the world,” bhuvana (world) plus ishvari (sovereign)
FORM	Golden or fair complexion, calm and maternal, seated on a lotus or throne, four arms
IMPLEMENTS	A noose (pasha) and a goad (ankusha), with two hands open in blessing and fearlessness
HER DOMAIN	Akāśa, space, the field within which time and all action unfold
FOCUS OF THESE PRACTICES	Noticing the space that is already here, prior to anything you do inside it

The Myth

Bhuvaneshvari does not have the kind of vivid, standalone story that Bagalamukhi or Dhumavati have. Like the other Mahavidyas, she is said to emerge from Sati’s fury surrounding Shiva at the time of Daksha’s sacrifice, taking her place among the ten directions that encircle him. Beyond that, her significance sits mainly in doctrine rather than narrative, worth knowing honestly rather than papering over with an origin story that is not really hers.

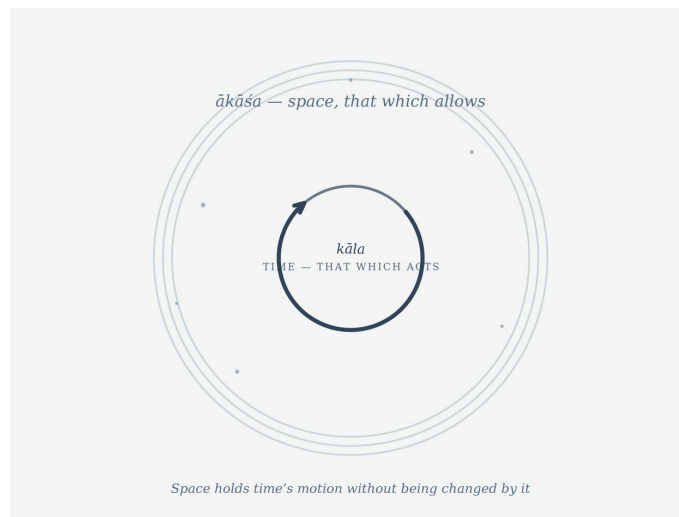
Symbolism and Image

Her two main implements, the noose and the goad, are worth understanding together rather than separately. The noose binds. It is the action of drawing something into form, pulling the unformed into shape, the way creation itself gathers what is formless into something that can be recognized as a world. The goad, an instrument used to direct an elephant, guides what has already been drawn into being, shaping it, keeping it moving in a given direction, giving it order rather than leaving it inert. Between them, the two objects describe the whole of what she does: bringing the world into existence, and holding it in a coherent shape once it is there.

Her other two hands, open in blessing and fearlessness, matter as much as the noose and goad. Whatever binding and directing she does happens without violence or threat. She is not imposing order on a reluctant universe. She is simply providing the space and structure within which anything can exist at all, closer to a container than a ruler in the way most people imagine rulership.

Understanding the Energy

The clearest way to understand her is by contrast with Kali. Kali is kala, time, the force that moves through everything and dissolves it. Bhuvaneshvari is akasha, space, the field within which time itself moves. Time acts. Space does not act; it simply allows action to happen inside it, without being changed by what happens there. This is a genuinely different kind of power than most of the other Mahavidyas represent, and it is worth sitting with the difference rather than collapsing her into a version of “gentle Kali.”



Space holds time's motion, without being changed by it

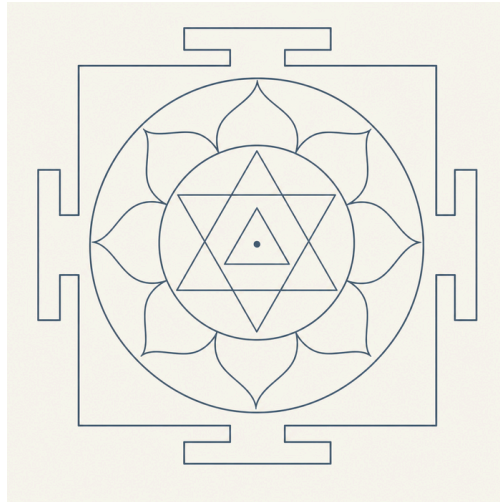
The Rudrayamala Tantra ties her specifically to chit-akasha, the space of consciousness itself: the field of awareness in which every thought, perception, and experience arises and passes, well beyond simple physical space. She is also connected to the five gross elements, pancha-mahabhuta, as the substratum from which those elements differentiate, the field prior to earth, water, fire, air, and space taking on their separate identities. In Shakta traditions she is frequently placed alongside Tripura Sundari: where Tripura Sundari is the light of consciousness itself, Bhuvaneshvari is the space that consciousness unfolds within. Two ways of pointing at something very close to the same thing.

How to Work With These Practices

Bhuvaneshvari's power is not something you generate. You do not build space, or earn it, or work your way toward it. It is already what is here, prior to anything you do inside it.

The practice here is not accomplishing anything new. It is noticing the space that was already present before you started trying to fill it, fix it, or control what is happening within it. Work with the practices below as a way of training attention onto that space directly, in the room around you, in your own mind, in conversation, and in how you meet other people. That is a different kind of effort than most spiritual practice asks for, and it can take real attention just to see what it is even pointing at.

Practices



The Bhuvaneshvari Yantra: the hexagram of space held within the lotus and bhupura

Bhuvaneshvari's practices do not build anything. Space is not something you generate, earn, or work your way toward; it is already what is here, prior to anything you do inside it.

Each day below trains attention onto that space directly, in the room around you, in your own mind, in speech, and in how you meet other people. This is a different kind of effort than most practice asks for. It can take real attention just to see what it is even pointing at.

Practice One – Space as Container

Practice. Pay attention to the space rather than the objects in it, wherever you are. Notice that it is the space that lets objects have form and definition; the unbound space is what defines the bound form. Practice the same thing with a glass of water or a bowl of food: the shape holds the contents, but it is the space inside the container that actually allows anything to fill it.

Evening reflection. Where today did I notice the container, rather than only what was inside it?

Practice Two – Widening Awareness

Practice. Use your peripheral vision instead of looking directly at things, widening your field of awareness as far as it will go. Try this looking at the sky, in daylight and at night, letting your attention stretch to encompass the whole visual field rather than any one point in it.

Evening reflection. What changed in my body when my attention widened instead of narrowing?

Practice Three – Space and Thought

Practice. Notice that thoughts, images, and ideas all appear within a boundless mental space. Pay more attention to the space the thoughts appear in than to the thoughts themselves. With emotion, instead of “I am angry,” notice that anger arises within space, within awareness, and that the space holds all of it, good or bad, without being changed by any of it.

Evening reflection. Did the space itself change today, or only what passed through it?

Practice Four – Releasing Contraction

Practice. Notice contraction wherever it shows up, especially in conflict or anything causing you to tighten. Practice relaxing the shoulders, calming the breath, unwinding the body, and ask directly: how can I create more space here? In situations you would normally try to manage or fix, practice acceptance instead of correcting, editing, or optimizing.

Evening reflection. Where did I tighten today, and what happened when I deliberately let it soften?

Practice Five – Space in Speech

Practice. Slow down or stop yourself from filling every silence today. Notice the moments you rush to fill quiet with words, and ask yourself honestly why. Let at least three silences in conversation stand unfilled longer than feels comfortable.

Evening reflection. What was I afraid would happen if I let the silence stay?

Practice Six – Space for Others

Practice. Be hospitable and spacious with the people around you today. Do not close others down or try to control them. Make room, physically and psychologically, for people to be exactly as they are. Listen without interrupting, and hold what others are feeling without trying to fix it.

Evening reflection. Could the people I was with today be fully themselves in my presence, or did they feel compressed?

Practice Seven – The Space That Does Not Change

Practice. Sit for twenty minutes and simply notice awareness itself, the space in which this entire sequence of thoughts, emotions, contractions, and conversations has been arising. Ask directly: has this awareness been altered by anything that has passed through it, or has it simply held all of it, exactly as the sky holds weather.

Evening reflection. What in me witnessed all of this without itself being changed by any of it?

Advanced Exercises

The Unfilled Room. Sit in an empty or near-empty room for ten minutes doing nothing, resisting the urge to pick up a phone, a book, or a task. Notice what the mind does when there is genuinely nothing to fill the space.

The Held Argument. The next time you feel the pull to win a disagreement or have the last word, deliberately make space for the other person's view to simply exist alongside yours, without needing to collapse the distance between them.

Sky Gazing. Lie or sit outdoors and look at open sky for fifteen minutes without naming clouds, colors, or shapes. Let the looking itself become spacious rather than analytical.

The Deeper Principle

Bhuvaneshvari is often quietly mistaken for a softer version of Kali, since both deal with something vast and impersonal. The distinction matters. Kali is kala, time, the force that moves through everything and dissolves it. Bhuvaneshvari is akasha, space, the field within which time itself moves. Time acts. Space allows action to happen inside it, without being changed by what happens there.

This is why her practices train attention rather than intensity. There is no fire to walk through here, no momentum to interrupt. There is only the plain, disorienting fact that awareness itself has never once been altered by anything it has witnessed, however dramatic, however painful, however joyful. Everything here asks of a student is designed to make that fact directly perceptible rather than merely understood as an idea.

Her Faculty

If each Mahavidya develops one irreplaceable human capacity, Bhuvaneshvari's is the capacity to remain unaltered while holding everything. Call it spacious containment: the ability to let thought, emotion, conflict, and other people be fully present without needing to close around any of it, correct it, or be changed by it.

This is not indifference, and it is not distance. A container that held nothing would not be containment at all. Bhuvaneshvari holds everything completely, and simply does not shrink, harden, or lose herself in the process. That is the specific steadiness her practices are designed to cultivate.

Tantraya · Tools for Transformation